

Research Ledger

Claims, sources, dates, classification

Product	AP Agent OS
Tier	Internal + citation source
Version	1.0
Date	September 2026
Use	Implementation toolkit

Responsibility is earned.

How to read this ledger

Every material market or performance claim in customer-facing files must appear here. Classification:

- Independent — analyst, academic, statutory, or unsponsored professional body
- Sponsored independent — analyst report underwritten by a vendor; method is the analyst's, distribution is sponsored
- Vendor — vendor marketing, product page, or vendor-commissioned figure
- Aggregator — secondary blog restating primary research; use only as a pointer back to primary
- Illustrative — Evidence Room worked example, not a market fact
- Framework — Evidence Room method, not an empirical claim

Do not invent statistics. If a figure cannot be tied to a source, remove it from customer copy.

AP operating benchmarks

ID	Claim	Source	Date	URL	Context	Class
B01	Average all-in cost to process one invoice is \$9.84	Ardent Partners, The State of ePayables 2025: AP's Unfinished Journey (n=204)	June 2025	https://ardentpartners.com/ardent-partners-the-state-of-epayables-2025/ and sponsored PDF via Bottomline	Table 1, all-inclusive cost including labour, technology, overhead, exception handling	Sponsored independent
B02	Average invoice cycle time is 8.2 days	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 1	Sponsored independent
B03	Average invoice exception rate is 18.4%	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 1; Ardent calls exceptions the largest reason other benchmarks are not lower	Sponsored independent
B04	35.4% of invoices process straight-through	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 1	Sponsored independent
B05	57.4% of suppliers submit invoices electronically	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 1	Sponsored independent
B06	65.4% of invoices are linked to a PO	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 1	Sponsored independent
B07	21.9% of staff time is spent managing supplier inquiries	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 1; described as flat	Sponsored independent
B08	Best-in-Class cost \$2.65 vs All Others \$12.42	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 2. Best-in-Class = top 20% by lowest cost and shortest cycle	Sponsored independent

ID	Claim	Source	Date	URL	Context	Class
B09	Best-in-Class cycle 2.9 days vs All Others 13.5	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 2	Sponsored independent
B10	Best-in-Class exception rate 11.1% vs All Others 20.9%	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 2. Ardent states BIC exception rates are 47% lower than the rest of the market	Sponsored independent
B11	Best-in-Class STP 51.0% vs All Others 29.0%	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 2	Sponsored independent
B12	Best-in-Class e-invoice supplier enablement 67.2% vs All Others 47.3%	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 2	Sponsored independent
B13	Best-in-Class PO-linked invoices 84.0% vs All Others 47.3%	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 2	Sponsored independent
B14	Best-in-Class supplier-inquiry time 12.8% vs All Others 24.0%	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Table 2	Sponsored independent
B15	Top 2025 AP challenges: approvals too long 49%; high exceptions 48%; fraud risk 31%	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Figure 2	Sponsored independent
B16	Top 2025 AP priorities: deploy ePayables 46%; improve reporting 44%; procurement collaboration 37%	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Figure 3	Sponsored independent
B17	44% of AP teams use AI in some capacity; 34% plan to within 12 months; 22% have no current plans	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Figure 8. "Using AI" includes ML, NLP and other AI-driven tools	Sponsored independent
B18	65% of AP leaders cite increasing automation as the primary AI objective	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Figure 10	Sponsored independent

ID	Claim	Source	Date	URL	Context	Class
B19	42% expect significant AI impact and 23% transformational impact in 2–3 years	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Figure 9	Sponsored independent
B20	72% of AP leaders see “smarter systems” as essential to future success	Same as B01	June 2025	Same	Figure 11	Sponsored independent

Market size (use with range language)

Market-size figures diverge because definitions differ (software only vs software + services; invoice processing vs broader AP automation; SME inclusion).

ID	Claim	Source	Date	URL	Context	Class
M01	AP automation market estimated at USD 6.94B in 2026, USD 12.46B in 2031, 12.44% CAGR	Mordor Intelligence, Accounts Payable Automation Market	2026 study window	https://www.mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/ap-automation-market	Includes cloud, e-invoicing and adjacent automation. Mordor notes other consultancies publish lower figures when services or SMEs are excluded	Independent (commercial research house)
M02	AP automation USD 3.07B (2023) to USD 7.1B (2030), 12.5% CAGR	Grand View Research, as restated by Nexus AP	2024/2025	https://www.nexusap.com/research/ap-automation-statistics-2026	Secondary restatement. Use as a range marker, not a single point	Aggregator of commercial research
M03	Invoice processing software USD 2.78B (2023) to USD 9.18B (2032), 14.2% CAGR	SkyQuest, as restated in industry round-ups	2024–2026	Secondary	Different scope from M01/M02	Aggregator

Customer-facing rule: say “analyst estimates for AP automation typically sit in the low-to-mid single-digit billions today, with double-digit CAGRs cited through 2030–2031” and point to the ledger. Do not pick one number and treat it as fact.

Governance and control frameworks

ID	Claim	Source	Date	URL	Context	Class
G01	NIST AI RMF 1.0 organises AI risk work as Govern, Map, Measure, Manage	NIST AI 100-1	January 2023 (living)	https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/ai/NIST.AI.100-1.pdf	Voluntary US framework. Not a certification	Independent (US government)

ID	Claim	Source	Date	URL	Context	Class
G02	ISO/IEC 42001 is a certifiable AI management system standard	ISO/IEC 42001:2023	2023	iso.org (standard)	Management system: roles, policies, monitoring, improvement	Independent
G03	COSO published Achieving Effective Internal Control Over Generative AI	COSO	23 February 2026	https://www.coso.org/generative-ai	Maps GenAI to the 2013 COSO IC framework (5 components, 17 principles)	Independent
G04	COSO emphasises AI reliance, logging, change control, and validation of outputs	KPMG summary of COSO GenAI roadmap	2026	https://kpmg.com/kpmg-us/content/dam/kpmg/frv/pdf/2026/coso-releases-gen-ai-roadmap.pdf	Secondary explanation of COSO	Independent (Big Four summary)

Lemon Squeezy commerce facts

ID	Claim	Source	Date	URL	Context	Class
C01	Lemon Squeezy is a Merchant of Record and remits sales tax / VAT	Lemon Squeezy pricing and MoR pages	Accessed Sep 2026	https://www.lemonsqueezy.com/pricing	Seller-of-record shifts to LS; still requires professional tax confirmation for the operator's own entity	Vendor
C02	Platform fee 5% + \$0.50 on order total (including tax)	Lemon Squeezy docs: Fees	Accessed Sep 2026	https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/getting-started/fees	Additional +1.5% international, +1.5% PayPal, +0.5% subscriptions	Vendor
C03	Abandoned-cart recovery +5%; affiliate referrals +3% (merchant)	Same	Accessed Sep 2026	Same	Marketing add-on fees	Vendor
C04	Worked example: €/\$20 product + 20% VAT → \$24 total → \$2.06 fee → \$17.94 net	Same	Accessed Sep 2026	Same	Official example	Vendor

Vendor claims (do not reuse as Evidence Room facts)

ID	Claim	Source	Class	Handling
V01	Medius cites header/line capture "99% accuracy" and agentic AP	medius.com autonomous AP	Vendor	Quote only as "vendor-stated"

ID	Claim	Source	Class	Handling
V02	HighRadius cites "95%+" capture accuracy and "100% audit readiness"	highradius.com AP automation	Vendor	Do not repeat as a market benchmark
V03	Stampli states AI always operates under human oversight inside its product	stampli.com/ai	Vendor	Useful as category language; not a performance metric
V04	Various vendors claim \$2.36 electronic processing floors	Vendor blogs / Ascend restatements	Vendor	Exclude from Evidence Room calculators as a default

Illustrative models used in this suite

ID	Description	Class
I01	Worked example: 15,000 invoices/month, 12 AP FTE, 22% exception rate, 12 minutes average exception handle	Illustrative
I02	Conservative / base / upside efficiency ranges in the business-case model (8% / 18% / 30% of exception labour)	Framework / illustrative
I03	First-agent 4–6 week bounded pilot	Framework — duration depends on systems, data, controls

What we deliberately did not claim

- Guaranteed savings or payback
- Guaranteed fraud or duplicate-payment prevention
- That Evidence Room is a registered audit methodology
- That any ERP is certified
- A single official AP automation market size
- That agentic AP is already the market standard (Ardent 2025 still shows AI adoption at 44% and mostly tactical)

This material is an implementation toolkit. It is not legal, tax, accounting, audit or investment advice. Agents do not authorise payments. Humans remain accountable. Statistics are cited in the Research Ledger.